

DAL by 8.5

78%

Neutral strength	DAL by 5.3
Site + calibration adjustment	+3.2
Final call	DAL by 8.5



SEA win 22% · pick'em (0) · DAL win 78%

Projected score DAL 87 — SEA 81 · Total 176 (market 174)

Some inputs served from the most-recent available build (winprob) — see companion file for detail.

Read

DAL is a clear favorite (78% to win). The catch: DAL is down a rotation piece — A. Fudd (impact +1.2) is OUT and already removed from the projection below.

- DAL is a clear favorite here (78% to win); we project DAL 87, SEA 81.
- Projected as a higher-scoring game (total near 176).
- Availability: DAL without A. James, A. Fudd, C. Verona (3 OUT); SEA without N. Hiedeman (1 OUT) — OUT players are excluded from the box; the minutes of any projected among them are redistributed into the rotation below.
- How sure: 4 games in 5 the DAL margin lands between -7 and +24 (+ = DAL ahead) — single games swing a lot, and even so DAL loses outright about 22% of the time.

Injuries & availability — out of the projected box

TEAM	PLAYER	STATUS / CAUSE	GAMES MISSED	EXP. RETURN
SEA	Natisha Hiedeman	Shoulder	1	Aug 26
DAL	Azzi Fudd	Knee	6	TBD
DAL	Aziaha James	Leg	3	Aug 30
DAL	Costanza Verona	Out	26	Sep 17

A deeper look

What tonight means

A win tonight puts DAL's playoff chances at 100% — a loss drops them to 100%.

Across both teams that makes this the 6th-biggest playoff-swing game of this week's 7 remaining games.

SEA

if they win

0%

if they lose

0%

Playoff swing: 0 points · Typical seed: about 15th either way.

DAL

if they win

100%

if they lose

100%

Playoff swing: 0 points · Typical seed: about 7th either way.

Source: the rest of the season replayed 10,000 times, split by tonight's result (may differ from the headline odds by a fraction of a point — same simulation, different run counts).

	#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
	54	M. Holmes F · 6'3" · college record	-0.8	2.8	0.8 0–11	0.6 0–5	0.1 0–3	0.0
27% of min, 22 GP · #178/212 league · 90%: pts 0-15 reb 0-6 ast 0-4 · 10.6 mpg, cap 29 · pctl 39/4/57/59/33 · Too little WNBA record to project from yet, so her line is projected from her own college record, which translates to 13.9 pts / 6.9 reb / 1.3 ast / 0.3 3PM per 36 minutes. Read the range, not the point · 2.9/3.1/0.5 per game								
		Team		200.0	81.4	38.7	17.1	8.4
ptctl = Offense / Defense / Playmaking / Rebounding / X-factor (2025 league percentile) · 90% = the range nine games in ten · players are projected from their last ten games unless the row says otherwise								

DAL

Projected lineup — seeded from the five who actually started this team's last game, on 2026-08-20; projected minutes fill any slot that lineup no longer covers.

	#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
	5	P. Bueckers	+1.2	33.4	19.7 14–30	3.9 2–8	5.1 3–8	1.4
84% of min, 33 GP · #18/212 league · 90%: pts 12-34 reb 2-9 ast 3-9 · 33.4 mpg, cap 38 · pctl 95/62/97/25/78 · 20.5/4.1/5.8 per game								
	24	A. Ogunbowale	-1.0	30.3	17.1 12–28	3.3 2–7	3.3 2–6	1.5
74% of min, 34 GP · #209/212 league · 90%: pts 9-31 reb 2-9 ast 1-7 · 29.6 mpg, cap 38 · pctl 72/74/89/3/33 · 19-25: -1.5/+0.7/+2.7/-0.2/+0.8/+1.8/+0.4, best 21 · 14.4/3.1/3.0 per game								
	32	J. Shepard	+0.2	24.8	10.5 6–21	7.6 5–12	3.5 2–6	0.1
80% of min, 32 GP · #66/212 league · 90%: pts 6-24 reb 4-13 ast 1-7 · 32.0 mpg, cap 40 · pctl 73/60/73/99/37 · 19-25: +0.4/-0.4/+0.0/-1.7/-0.5, best 19 · 14.2/11.2/5.2 per game								
	8	A. Smith	+1.0	24.3	9.9 4–21	6.1 3–10	1.3 0–4	1.1
44% of min, 27 GP · #45/212 league · 90%: pts 3-24 reb 3-11 ast 0-5 · 17.4 mpg, cap 38 · pctl 60/72/70/71/74 · 19-25: +0.7/-0.3/-0.2/-0.8/+1.2/+2.6/+1.5, best 24 · 5.7/4.0/1.1 per game								
	34	A. Kuier	+0.1	22.8	8.3 6–19	5.0 3–9	1.5 1–4	1.0
40% of min, 31 GP · #89/212 league · 90%: pts 6-22 reb 3-10 ast 1-5 · 15.9 mpg, cap 38 · 21-23: +0.2/+0.9/-2.5, best 22 · 5.5/3.1/0.9 per game								
	1	O. Sims	-0.6	17.3	6.2 1–17	1.6 0–6	2.3 1–5	0.6
39% of min, 25 GP · #180/212 league · 90%: pts 0-20 reb 0-7 ast 0-6 · 15.6 mpg, cap 34 · pctl 34/31/90/10/47 · 18-25: +1.1/+0.4/+0.2/-1.1/-0.5/-0.4/+1.1/+0.6, best 17 · 5.6/1.0/2.2 per game								
	7	A. Clark	-1.9	13.3	2.9 0–14	2.2 0–6	0.9 0–4	0.4
26% of min, 21 GP · #198/212 league · 90%: pts 0-17 reb 0-7 ast 0-5 · 10.4 mpg, cap 28 · pctl 1/27/41/44/96 · 17-25: +1.1/+0.9/+1.6/+2.4/+0.9/+0.9/-0.7/-1.4, best 20 · 2.2/1.3/0.5 per game								
	20	M. Siegrist	+0.5	11.7	4.9 0–16	2.4 0–6	0.8 0–4	0.5
34% of min, 31 GP · #63/212 league · 90%: pts 0-19 reb 0-8 ast 0-5 · 13.7 mpg, cap 29 · pctl 75/48/34/49/60 · 23-25: +1.4/+0.2/+1.5, best 25 · 5.9/2.7/0.9 per game								
	28	L. Yueru	+0.3	10.8	3.6 0–14	2.6 0–7	0.3 0–3	0.3
25% of min, 25 GP · #82/212 league · 90%: pts 0-18 reb 0-8 ast 0-4 · 10.1 mpg, cap 30 · pctl 44/58/20/88/28 · 22-25: -0.4/-0.6/-0.4, best 25 · 3.2/2.8/0.4 per game								
	30	H. Jones	-0.2	6.4	2.5	1.3	0.6	0.1
22% of min, 7 GP · #124/212 league · 8.7 mpg, cap 16 · pctl 29/23/52/53/48 · 23-25: +0.4/+1.1/-0.7, best 24 · 4.0/1.7/0.7 per game								
	0	S. Sutton	-0.2	4.9	1.0	0.6	0.9	0.1

	#	PLAYER	IMPACT	MIN	PTS	REB	AST	3PM
26% of min, 19 GP · #128/212 league · 10.3 mpg, cap 28 · pctlte 16/82/84/1/61 · 20-25: -0.7/-0.5/-1.0/+0.5, best 25 · 3.6/0.8/1.9 per game								
		Team		200.0	86.6	36.6	20.5	7.1
pctlte = Offense / Defense / Playmaking / Rebounding / X-factor (2025 league percentile) · 90% = the range nine games in ten · players are projected from their last ten games unless the row says otherwise								

These two teams

	SEA	DAL
ROTATION IMPACT (minutes-weighted)	+0.04 (12 of 12 rated)	+0.07 (11 of 11 rated)
PROJECTED SCORE	81	87
SEASON RECORD	7-30	21-16
RECENT FORM (last 10)	1-9 · -5.2 avg margin	3-7 · -2.9 avg margin

DAL leads the season series 2-0. 06-01 at DAL: SEA 56–DAL 79 · 06-22 at SEA: SEA 110–DAL 112. In 2025 they met 4 times, SEA winning 3.

Who moved the win probability on 06-22 — DAL 112–SEA 110.

This is an exact account of THAT GAME, not a rating of these players. It adds up every swing in win probability that happened while each player was on the floor. Because it describes a game that was already played rather than predicting one, it is exact — but it is also close to useless as a forecast: a player's number here tells us almost nothing about her next game, and it is not a ranking of who is good. Read it as a record of how this one night unfolded.

SEA · F. Johnson +2.8 (31 min, 23 stints) · T. Mair -16.3 (8 min, 7 stints) · D. Malonga -17.7 (30 min, 20 stints) · N. Hiedeman -29.9 (29 min, 19 stints) · S. Dolson -34.0 (12 min, 11 stints) · K. Lou Samuelson -38.2 (19 min, 13 stints) · A. Fam -40.7 (31 min, 21 stints) · Z. Cooke -57.1 (23 min, 16 stints) · **total -231.1**

DAL · A. James +69.2 (18 min, 14 stints) · L. Yueru +62.4 (17 min, 13 stints) · A. Fudd +48.9 (34 min, 24 stints) · M. Siegrist +35.4 (12 min, 9 stints) · S. Sutton +33.3 (10 min, 7 stints) · J. Shepard +21.0 (28 min, 20 stints) · P. Bueckers +10.4 (30 min, 22 stints) · A. Ogunbowale -23.4 (18 min, 10 stints) · A. Kuier -26.0 (15 min, 11 stints) · **total +231.2**

Win probability is in points, so +10.0 means a player was on the floor for swings worth ten points of it. Each total is simply the numbers beside it added up. They run large because five players share the floor for every move and each is charged with all of it, so a side adds to five times its own swing in the game; that holds to the last decimal before rounding, and the two sides can differ by a tenth once each player is rounded. DAL won that night.

Sources: rotation impact = each player's on-court impact rating weighted by the minutes we project her to play tonight; records, form and past meetings = completed game results only, never tonight's. Who moved the win probability = every on-court stint of that one completed meeting added up per player — a description of that game, never a forecast and never a season number.

THE SEASON SO FAR (through 426 games): Our spread calls miss by an average of 10.7 points · when we make a team a 60%+ favorite, they win 72% of the time · player minutes within +/-5.0, points within +/-4.1 (player lines: reconstructed day-before for all 143 games; live tracking began Jul 8.)

Recent monthly accuracy (average miss, lower is better): May '25 9.9 · Jun '25 10.7 · Jul '25 11.7 · Aug '25 10.0 · Sep '25 10.3 · May '26 11.1 · Jun '26 10.6 · Jul '26 12.2 points.

all-games: spread +/-10.7 · minutes +/-5.1 · points +/-4.1

Legend: big # = jersey · bold above the line = projected starters · IMPACT = points added vs an average player per 100 possessions (— = not yet rated, † = rated off her earlier record) · the grey figure under a number is the range it lands in four times in five · the grey strip under a player is her context: rank, floor-time share, wider ranges, minutes, percentiles, foul risk, what the numbers rest on, season averages · shaded either side of pick'em = each team's win chance, dark tick = our call · games missed = team games since she last appeared. How the numbers are made: this game's companion notes.

Generated 2026-08-23T04:04:12Z · dense report of record · midnight projected drop. Built by The Hardwood from existing production models — no new models and no hand-entered numbers. Full methodology and sources are in this game's companion notes.